



MARKET MONITOR

No. 67 – April 2019

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The latest AMIS forecasts published in this report incorporate the long-awaited historical revisions to China's supply and demand balances for maize, wheat and rice (for more background, please see AMIS Market Monitors, No. 64 and No. 65). The upward adjustments to production have been largely accommodated by raising the estimates for utilization (in particular feed use) and stocks. The revised data can be downloaded from the [AMIS database](#) while a short explanatory note about the revision along with old and new balances are available from FAO's website, under [Cereal Supply and Demand Brief](#). Despite this month's significant revisions, the underlying trends in world supply and demand for the four AMIS crops in 2018/19 remain broadly unchanged from the previous report. Indeed, the market's attention is shifting to the outlook for the 2019/20 season with first forecasts to be published in next month's report.

Markets at a glance

	From previous forecast	From previous season
Wheat	▼	▼
Maize	▲	▼
Rice	▲	▲
Soybeans	▼	▲

▲ Easing

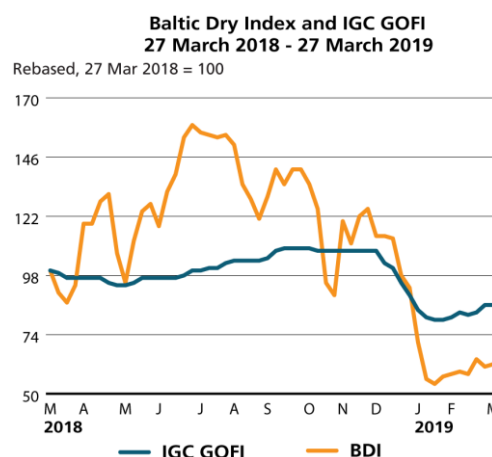
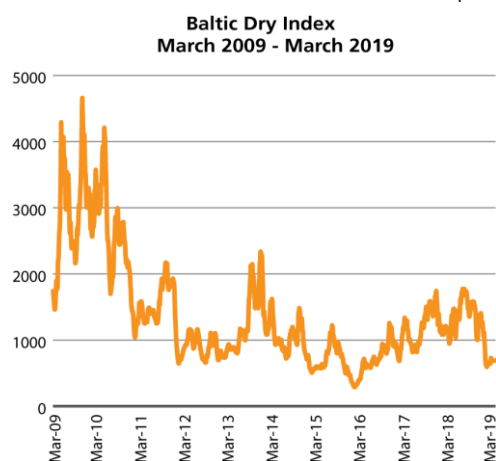
■ Neutral

▼ Tightening

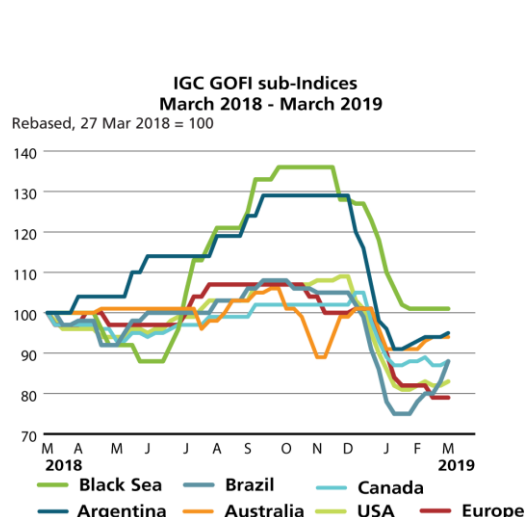
The **Market Monitor** is a product of the Agricultural Market Information System (AMIS). It covers international markets for wheat, maize, rice and soybeans, giving a synopsis of major market developments and the policy and other market drivers behind them. The analysis is a collective assessment of the market situation and outlook by the ten international organizations and entities that form the AMIS Secretariat.

Grains/oilseeds freight markets: Mixed prospects following a slump

Freight markets slumped in January as disappointing spot demand and concerns about weakening global economic growth dashed expectations for a strong start to the season. With early pressure compounded by seasonal holidays in Asia, coupled with a fallout from a mining dam collapse in Brazil, the Baltic Dry Index (BDI) – a benchmark for costs across dry bulk segments – slid to its lowest in around two and a half years in late-February. Despite a slight recovery since then, the Index was still 38 percent lower y/y as at late-March, reflecting a market which continues to grapple with overcapacity. In a longer-term perspective, the Index remains well below historic peaks of a decade ago.



Although prices for ocean transportation of grains and oilseeds displayed a steadier tone over the past year they, too, fell sharply in 2019. This can be illustrated by the International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Freight Index (GOFI), which provides a measure of freight rates across selected heavy grains and oilseeds routes. The Index touched a 17-month low in mid-February and was down by 14 percent y/y as at 27 March. Although all GOFI sub-Indices stabilised or advanced recently, led by Brazil, which saw particularly strong soybean shipments, prospects for grains/oilseeds freight markets across key exporting origins remain mixed, in part because of variable trade forecasts.



IGC GOFI sub-Indices
27 March 2018 - 27 March 2019

	1 Jan 2013 = 100	27 March 2019	Month Ago	% Chg	Year Ago	% Chg
GOFI		114.84	108.99	+5.4%	133.81	-14.2%
sub-Indices:						
Argentina		145.09	143.44	+1.2%	153.51	-5.5%
Australia		91.87	88.59	+3.7%	97.40	-5.7%
Brazil		132.27	116.63	+13.4%	149.87	-11.7%
Black Sea		180.39	181.12	-0.4%	178.59	+1.0%
Canada		116.16	116.69	-0.5%	132.15	-12.1%
Europe		115.15	118.54	-2.9%	145.02	-20.6%
US		96.70	95.04	+1.7%	116.42	-16.9%

Whether the current positive momentum in the grains and oilseeds carrying sectors is just a short-lived correction or the beginning of a longer-term trend remains to be seen. Sustained flows could support a recovery, however values remain vulnerable to periodic shifts and volatility amid persistent headwinds. These include persistent overcapacity (expected annual fleet growth of about 3 percent for 2019 outweighs a projected 1-2 percent expansion in the seaborne trade of main dry bulk commodities); geopolitical uncertainties, including the US-China trade conflict; costs associated with the forthcoming low emissions regulations (IMO 2020); and lastly, deteriorating macroeconomic conditions in many countries.

World supply-demand outlook

World Balances, with and without China*

		In million tonnes							
		FAO-AMIS			USDA		IGC		
		2017/18 est.	2018/19 f'cast		2017/18 est.	2018/19 f'cast	2017/18 est.	2018/19 f'cast	
			7-Mar	4-Apr		8-Mar		28-Mar	
• Wheat production in 2018 revised upward based on a new estimate for China, but still down 3.8 percent from the 2017 record mostly because of sharp projected reductions in Australia and the Russian Federation. • Utilization in 2018/19 raised on a higher estimate for China and the Russian Federation; up 1.2 percent from 2017/18, driven by firm demand in Asia. • Trade in 2018/19 (July/June) nearly unchanged m/m; down 3.6 percent from 2017/18 on lower anticipated shipments to several countries in North Africa as well as in Asia. • Stocks (ending in 2019) scaled up m/m but still down 14 million tonnes from the record opening, mostly on sharp expected drawdowns in the EU and the Russian Federation.	Production	759.9	728.3	730.9	763.1	733.0	763.5	734.9	
		625.6	600.3	599.4	628.7	601.6	629.1	603.4	
	Supply	1,022.0	1,003.6	1,011.8	1,024.0	1,012.6	1,011.8	1,005.6	
		791.4	770.6	768.6	774.8	749.9	776.8	759.9	
	Utilization	739.5	741.8	748.1	744.4	742.1	741.1	741.8	
• Maize 2018 production lifted by 4.0 percent, primarily because of an upward revision in China, but still down 1.8 percent from the 2017 record. • Utilization in 2018/19 revised up, mostly reflecting adjustments to feed use estimates in China, and growing by 2.4 percent from 2017/18. • Trade in 2018/19 (July/June) nearly unchanged m/m and still pointing to a 2.7 percent expansion from 2017/18 supported by bigger purchases by the EU and several Asian countries. • Stocks (ending in 2019) scaled up significantly m/m following revisions in China and, to a lesser extent, in the EU, South Africa and the US.		616.9	621.1	621.6	623.4	617.1	617.7	614.0	
	Trade	176.8	171.0	170.5	181.2	178.9	175.2	171.1	
		172.9	167.9	167.4	176.2	174.2	171.4	167.2	
	Stocks	280.9	264.7	267.0	279.6	270.5	270.7	263.8	
		169.2	149.4	147.3	148.4	130.5	155.3	142.1	
• Rice production estimate for 2018 raised, with a higher number for China only partially offsetting lower estimates for Thailand. • Trade in 2019 lowered m/m, with reduced shipments from India driving the adjustment; pointing to a 2.6 percent decline from 2018. • Utilization in 2018/19 to grow 0.8 percent catalysed by greater food intake. • Stocks (2018/19 carry-out) anticipated to expand 3.9 percent and revised up m/m based on higher carryover expansions in China and India.	Production	1,137.5	1,074.4	1,117.2	1,076.2	1,101.2	1,090.5	1,114.4	
		878.4	857.9	859.9	817.2	843.8	831.4	857.1	
	Supply	1,485.5	1,381.8	1,482.7	1,426.9	1,442.3	1,455.4	1,452.2	
		1,017.0	1,018.5	1,020.1	944.8	962.5	960.4	974.2	
	Utilization	1,109.7	1,111.7	1,136.0	1,085.7	1,133.8	1,117.7	1,147.6	
• Soybean 2018/19 production forecast lowered slightly, with reduced forecasts for Brazil and other South American countries offset in part by higher estimates elsewhere. • Utilization in 2018/19 virtually unchanged m/m, as fresh downward revisions for China and other countries in Asia were mostly compensated by upward corrections in India. • Trade in 2018/19 trimmed further, tied to lower-than-earlier anticipated demand in China and other countries in Asia. • Stocks (2018/19 carry-out) scaled down for the third consecutive month, with lower forecasts for Argentina and the US only partly offset by upward revisions for Brazil.		843.1	867.1	865.2	822.7	853.8	839.7	861.1	
	Trade	155.4	160.0	159.5	146.6	167.0	152.4	161.3	
		151.0	156.5	156.0	143.1	161.9	148.7	156.8	
	Stocks	365.5	267.0	344.9	341.2	308.5	337.7	304.6	
		160.2	145.3	150.0	118.6	103.7	117.0	108.6	
• Rice production estimate for 2018 raised, with a higher number for China only partially offsetting lower estimates for Thailand. • Trade in 2019 lowered m/m, with reduced shipments from India driving the adjustment; pointing to a 2.6 percent decline from 2018. • Utilization in 2018/19 to grow 0.8 percent catalysed by greater food intake. • Stocks (2018/19 carry-out) anticipated to expand 3.9 percent and revised up m/m based on higher carryover expansions in China and India.	Production	509.5	514.9	516.4	495.4	501.6	494.3	499.8	
		363.8	372.4	371.1	346.5	353.1	345.4	351.3	
	Supply	679.4	687.4	690.9	645.3	664.2	636.6	650.3	
		433.6	441.9	440.5	398.0	406.7	403.9	411.3	
	Utilization	506.4	509.3	510.6	482.7	492.0	486.1	493.3	
• Soybean 2018/19 production forecast lowered slightly, with reduced forecasts for Brazil and other South American countries offset in part by higher estimates elsewhere. • Utilization in 2018/19 virtually unchanged m/m, as fresh downward revisions for China and other countries in Asia were mostly compensated by upward corrections in India. • Trade in 2018/19 trimmed further, tied to lower-than-earlier anticipated demand in China and other countries in Asia. • Stocks (2018/19 carry-out) scaled down for the third consecutive month, with lower forecasts for Argentina and the US only partly offset by upward revisions for Brazil.		361.3	365.7	364.4	340.3	348.2	341.8	348.4	
	Trade	47.8	47.1	46.6	47.1	47.4	46.6	47.0	
		43.0	42.5	42.0	40.2	40.7	42.1	42.6	
	Stocks	174.6	177.6	181.5	162.6	172.2	150.5	156.9	
		69.5	73.5	75.0	53.6	56.2	57.6	58.5	
• Soybean 2018/19 production forecast lowered slightly, with reduced forecasts for Brazil and other South American countries offset in part by higher estimates elsewhere. • Utilization in 2018/19 virtually unchanged m/m, as fresh downward revisions for China and other countries in Asia were mostly compensated by upward corrections in India. • Trade in 2018/19 trimmed further, tied to lower-than-earlier anticipated demand in China and other countries in Asia. • Stocks (2018/19 carry-out) scaled down for the third consecutive month, with lower forecasts for Argentina and the US only partly offset by upward revisions for Brazil.	Production	341.7	361.5	360.6	340.5	360.1	340.9	358.8	
		326.5	345.5	344.6	325.3	344.2	325.6	342.8	
	Supply	398.7	402.6	401.6	436.3	458.6	389.8	403.8	
		368.8	373.2	372.2	400.4	419.2	351.1	369.3	
	Utilization	349.1	353.0	352.7	338.1	348.5	344.6	351.6	
• Soybean 2018/19 production forecast lowered slightly, with reduced forecasts for Brazil and other South American countries offset in part by higher estimates elsewhere. • Utilization in 2018/19 virtually unchanged m/m, as fresh downward revisions for China and other countries in Asia were mostly compensated by upward corrections in India. • Trade in 2018/19 trimmed further, tied to lower-than-earlier anticipated demand in China and other countries in Asia. • Stocks (2018/19 carry-out) scaled down for the third consecutive month, with lower forecasts for Argentina and the US only partly offset by upward revisions for Brazil.		238.5	245.7	245.8	231.8	243.4	236.0	248.2	
	Trade	152.8	151.5	149.8	153.0	154.2	152.7	153.2	
		58.7	63.5	62.2	58.7	66.1	60.2	66.3	
	Stocks	41.0	52.3	51.9	98.6	107.2	45.0	51.8	
		27.6	42.3	41.9	75.0	85.0	26.5	34.1	



World Balances

* Data shown in the second rows refer to world aggregates without China; world trade data refer to exports and world trade without China excludes exports to China.

To review and compare data, by country and commodity, across three main sources, go to <https://app.amis-outlook.org/#/market-database>

Estimates and forecasts may differ across sources for many reasons, including different methodologies. For more information see Explanatory notes on the last page of this report.

Summary of revisions to FAO-AMIS monthly forecasts for 2018/19

in thousand tonnes

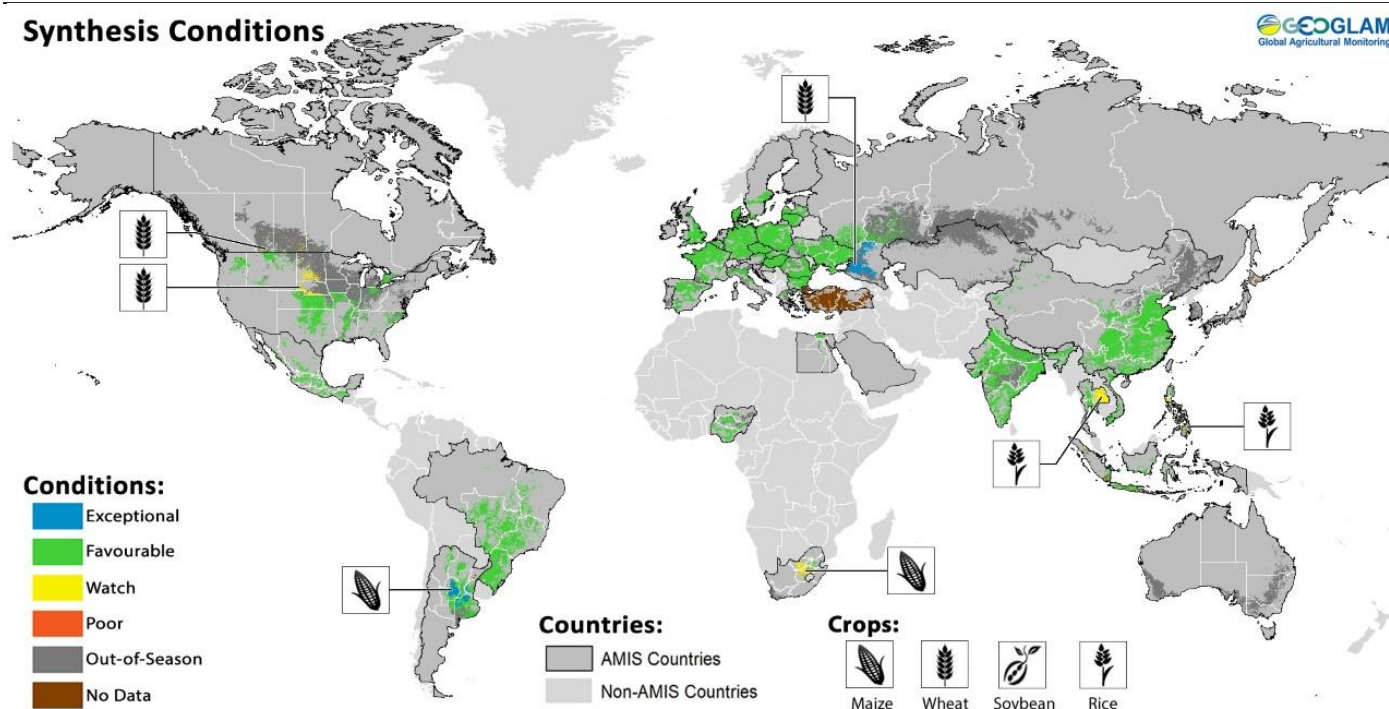
	WHEAT					MAIZE				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	2592	-496	6304	-495	2321	42800	-494	24246	-494	77878
Total AMIS	3432	-500	6804	-570	3547	42254	-250	23324	-165	78116
Argentina	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Australia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Brazil	-	-	-	-	-	-77	-	-77	-	-
Canada	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
China Mainland	3432	-	5760	-	4418	40830	-	26135	-	73176
Egypt	-	-	-	-	-296	-	-200	-400	-	-100
EU	-	-	200	-200	-	1500	-	-500	500	1500
India	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Indonesia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Japan	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Mexico	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-165	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-	-500	-220	-	-	-	-150	-	-	-200
Russian Fed.	-	-	1200	600	-1800	-	-	-300	-	200
Saudi Arabia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-	-	-	-	100	-900	-	1000
Thailand	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Turkey	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Ukraine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
US	-	-	-136	-970	1225	-	-	-635	-500	2540
Viet Nam	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

	RICE					SOYBEANS				
	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks	Production	Imports	Utilization	Exports	Stocks
WORLD	1453	-453	1300	-500	3829	-922	-1708	-325	-1705	-395
Total AMIS	1501	4	1202	-400	3981	128	-898	475	-775	-170
Argentina	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	300	-500
Australia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Brazil	-	-	-26	-	-44	-1044	-	-94	-1000	500
Canada	-	-	-1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
China Mainland	2813	-	2613	-	2400	-	-400	-400	-	-
Egypt	-	-	-	-	-	-	-280	-280	-	-
EU	-	-	20	-	-	272	-	272	-	-
India	261	4	-136	-350	1600	900	-40	835	-75	100
Indonesia	-	-	4	-	-	-	-200	-200	-	-
Japan	-	-	-20	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Kazakhstan	-	-	-	-	-5	-	-	-	-	-
Mexico	-	-	-28	-	-	-	-50	-	-	-
Nigeria	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Philippines	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Rep. of Korea	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Russian Fed.	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Saudi Arabia	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
South Africa	-	-	-30	-	30	-	-	-	-	-
Thailand	-1573	-	-1193	-	-80	-	-	-	-	-
Turkey	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Ukraine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
US	-	-	-1	-50	80	-	-	270	-	-270
Viet Nam	-	-	-	-	-	-	72	72	-	-

Crop monitor

Crop conditions in AMIS countries (as of 28 March)

Synthesis Conditions



Crop condition map synthesizing information for all four AMIS crops as of 28 March. Crop conditions over the main growing areas for wheat, maize, rice, and soybean are based on a combination of national and regional crop analyst inputs along with earth observation data. **Only crops that are in other-than-favourable conditions are displayed on the map with their crop symbol.**

Conditions at a glance

Wheat - In the northern hemisphere, winter wheat is under favourable conditions with southern areas emerging from dormancy early in many places with above normal growth.

Maize - In the southern hemisphere, conditions are favourable across most countries. Exceptional conditions are present at the start of harvest for early-planted maize in Argentina, while conditions remain mixed in South Africa at a crucial stage for final yield development.

Rice – In China and India, conditions are favourable. In Southeast Asia, conditions are mixed in the northern countries for dry-season rice, with dry conditions in the Philippines and Thailand. Wet-season rice is advancing favourably in Indonesia.

Soybeans - In the southern hemisphere, harvesting is ongoing in Brazil and Argentina under favourable conditions, with average to potentially above-average yields expected, respectively.

El Niño advisory

Weak-to-moderate El Niño-Southern Oscillation (ENSO) conditions are present and are forecast to continue during the Northern Hemisphere spring (80 percent chance for April to June) and summer (60 percent chance for June to August).

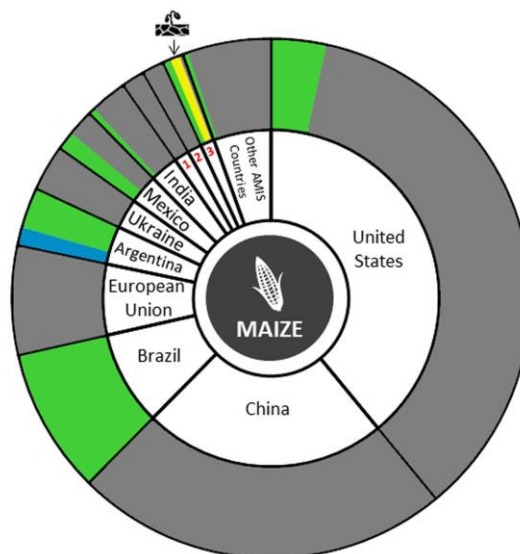
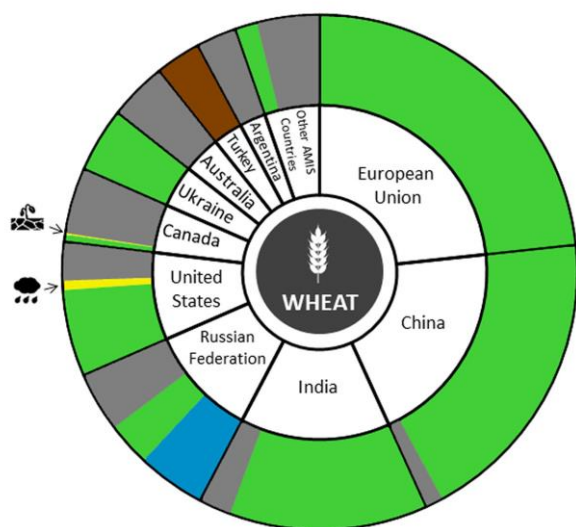
Associated with this event are increased chances of above normal April to June rainfall in parts of the southeastern US, central Asia, and southeastern South America, and increased chances of below normal rainfall in Southeast Asia, particularly for the maritime region, and in parts of eastern Southern Africa and northern South America.

El Niño conditions during June to August would typically increase chances of below normal rainfall in Indonesia, the Philippines, northern and eastern Australia, India, Central America and parts of the Caribbean, northern South America, and northern Ethiopia. Forecasts are also tending towards a positive Indian Ocean Dipole mode during June to August. Such conditions tend to suppress rainfall in parts of Australia.

Conditions:



Drivers:



Canada¹, Russian Federation², South Africa³

Wheat

In the **EU**, winter wheat conditions are generally favourable, but additional rainfall is needed in southern Europe in the coming month. In **Ukraine**, a very warm start to March has led to winter wheat growth being two to three weeks ahead of normal, which tends to be a positive factor for final yields. In the **Russian Federation**, winter wheat conditions are off to an exceptional start in the Southern region, while areas further north remain in dormancy under favourable conditions. In **China**, conditions for winter wheat are generally favourable as warmer than average weather is bringing the crop out of dormancy earlier than normal. In **India**, winter wheat is progressing towards maturity stage under favourable conditions. Total sown area is in line with the previous year. In the **US**, winter wheat conditions are favourable in the main producing area of the southern Great Plains. Further north, in Nebraska and the Dakotas, very wet and snowy conditions are raising concerns. In **Canada**, winter wheat conditions are favourable for the dormant crop in the main producing provinces. However, delays in sowing in the fall, along with an increased risk of winterkill, may reduce production in the southern Prairies.

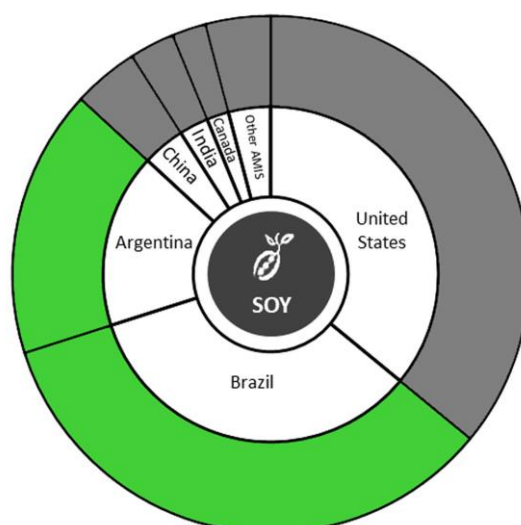
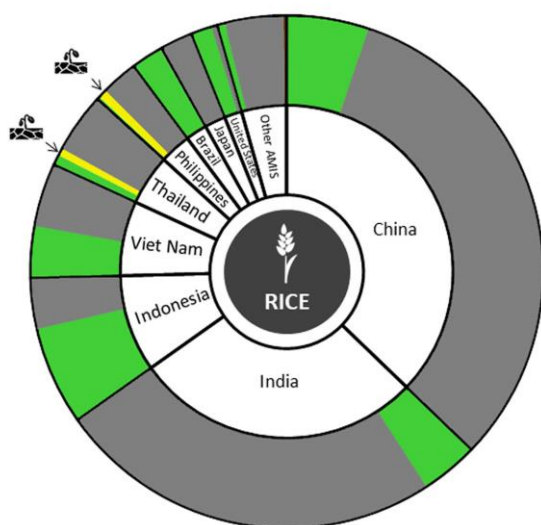
Maize

In **Brazil**, harvesting is advancing for the spring-planted crop and average yields are expected. Sowing of the summer-planted crop (higher producing season) is progressing under favourable conditions. A slight increase in total sown area is expected. In **Argentina**, harvest of the spring-planted crop has begun under exceptional conditions in the main producing areas. Conditions are favourable for the summer-planted crops. In **Mexico**, conditions are favourable for both the spring-summer cycle and autumn-winter crops. In **South Africa**, conditions are mixed as dry conditions in the western production area early in the season reduced sown area, and current warm and dry conditions continue to put pressure on yields. Rainfall over the short term will be crucial to determining final yields. In **India**, conditions are favourable for the Rabi crop as sowing is complete and total sown area is close to average. In the **US**, sowing of maize has begun in the southern states under favourable conditions.



Pie chart description: Each slice represents a country's share of total AMIS production (5-year average), with the main producing countries (95 percent of production) shown individually and the remaining 5 percent grouped into the "Other AMIS Countries" category. Sections within each country are weighted by the sub-national production statistics (5-year average) of the respective country and accounts for multiple cropping seasons (i.e. spring and winter wheat).

The late vegetative through to reproductive crop growth stages are generally the most sensitive periods for crop development.

Conditions:**Drivers:****Rice**

In **China**, early-crop rice conditions are favourable with plentiful rainfall for irrigation. In **India**, transplanting of the Rabi rice is complete and under favourable conditions. In **Indonesia**, conditions are favourable as sowing of wet-season rice enters into the final month. Harvest of the earlier sown fields continues with yields expected to be close to average owing to sufficient sunlight during the growing season. In **Viet Nam**, conditions are favourable for winter-spring rice (dry-season rice) with sowing complete in the south and continuing in the north. Total sown area is noticeably higher in the north compared to last year due to warm weather. In **Thailand**, dry-season rice is being harvested under general favourable conditions with the exception of dry conditions in the northeastern region, which will potentially reduce final yields. In the **Philippines**, dry-season rice is in the maturing to harvesting stages under mixed conditions. Dry conditions in the southern areas during the critical growth stage may affect final yields. In **Brazil**, harvesting is ongoing with a noticeable decrease expected in production compared to last year due to a reduction in sown area. In the **US**, sowing is beginning in the south under favourable conditions.

Soybeans

In **Brazil**, conditions are favourable as the harvest progresses. A slight reduction in final production is expected compared to the previous year due to dry conditions in the South and Central-West regions during December and January. Overall yields are estimated to be near average. In **Argentina**, harvest has begun for spring-planted crops under favourable conditions. Summer-planted crops are under favourable conditions, with earlier sown crops showing better performance than later sown crops. A frost in the last week of February in southern Buenos Aires and La Pampa resulted in only minor losses.

Information on crop conditions in non-AMIS countries can be found in the [GEOGLAM Early Warning Crop Monitor](#), published 4 April 2019

Sources and Disclaimers: The Crop Monitor assessment is conducted by GEOGLAM with inputs from the following partners (in alphabetical order): Argentina (Buenos Aires Grains Exchange, INTA), Asia Rice Countries (AFSIS, ASEAN+3 & Asia RICE), Australia (ABARES & CSIRO), Brazil (CONAB & INPE), Canada (AAFC), China (CAS), EU (EC JRC MARS), Indonesia (LAPAN & MOA), International (CIMMYT, FAO, IFPRI & IIRI), Japan (JAXA), Mexico (SIAP), Russian Federation (IKI), South Africa (ARC & GeoTerraImage & SANSA), Thailand (GISTDA & OAE), Ukraine (NASU-NSAU & UHMC), USA (NASA, UMD, USGS – FEWS NET, USDA (FAS, NASS)), Viet Nam (VAST & VIMHE-MARD). The findings and conclusions in this joint multiagency report are consensual statements from the GEOGLAM experts, and do not necessarily reflect those of the individual agencies represented by these experts. More detailed information on the GEOGLAM crop assessments is available at www.geoglam-crop-monitor.org

Policy developments

Wheat

- On 4 March, **Australia** and **Indonesia** signed a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (IA-CEPA) under which Indonesia will issue automatic import permits for duty-free access of 500 000 tonnes of feed grains, including wheat, in the first year. The tariff quota volume will be increased by 5 percent annually thereafter. IA-CEPA is expected to come into force in 2020, pending ratification by the Indonesian House of Representatives and the Australian Parliament.
- On 12 March, to reflect higher production costs, **Brazil** approved new minimum guarantee prices for all wheat grain and seed varieties for the agriculture year 2019/20. Prices were raised by 12.16 percent on average compared to 2018/19 and vary according to region and wheat type. In the key producing Southern region, the minimum price for bread wheat was raised to BRL 40.57 per 60 kg (USD 177.2 per tonne), up from BRL 36.17 (USD 157.8 per tonne); and prices of wheat seeds increased from BRL 1.48 per kg (USD 39 per tonne) to BRL 1.66 per kg (USD 43 per tonne).
- On 12 March, Agriculture and Agri-Food **Canada** announced an investment of up to CAD 6.2 million (USD 4.6 million) funded through the Agri-Marketing Program to assist the Canadian International Grains Institute in expanding market access opportunities for wheat through technical support, market research, employee exchanges and customized training for customers and commercial partners worldwide.

Maize

- On 13 March, the Ministry of Production and Work in **Argentina** approved a new biotechnology variety, the *Powercore Ultra Enlist*, that improves pest management in the maize sector (Resolution No. 20/2019) and enhances the control of resistant weeds.

Rice

- On 7 March, the **EU** increased the import duty for non-basmati husked rice originating in countries not party to a preferential trade agreement with the EU, falling within CN code 1006 20, from EUR 30 to EUR 65 (from USD 33.8 to USD 73.1) per tonne (Regulation 2019/371). The new tariff became effective on 8 March 2019.
- On 13 March, with a view to reducing its rice import bill, the Ministry of Agriculture in **Egypt** announced a 37.5 percent increase in the rice cultivation area from 800 000 acres in 2018 to 1.1 million acres in 2019.

Soybeans

- **China's** Heilongjiang Province, the country's top grower for soybeans and maize, will keep soybean subsidies at CNY 300 per mu (USD 743.7 per hectare) in 2019 compared to CNY 320 per mu (USD 794.5 per hectare) in 2018.

Logistics/Infrastructure/Trade Junctions

- Three ports in the Entre Rios Province in **Argentina** have reopened after eight years of closure, which is expected to boost rice exports from the Province.
- Extreme floods in the Midwestern **US** significantly obstructed barge freight as multiple locks had to close along the Ohio and Mississippi Rivers.

Across the board

- On 13 March, the Ministry of Agriculture and Agribusiness in **Argentina** launched *Agrodatos*, a transparency tool to enhance information management in the agriculture sector. The system assists agriculture suppliers with data management and systematisation of registry.
- On 8 March, the Ministry of Agriculture, Livestock and Farming in **Brazil** launched a new crop registration system, the "National Register of Cultivars", which is intended to facilitate the analysis of applications for cultivar registration and to allow systematization of information.
- On 5 March, the Ministry of Commerce and Industry in **India** notified a Transport and Marketing Assistance Scheme applicable for certain agriculture products, including maize products from 1 March 2019 to 21 March 2020. The scheme assists exporters through direct bank transfers in reimbursement of freight costs and promotes the marketing of agricultural produce worldwide.
- On 6 March, **Japan** notified the WTO of a proposal to revoke the designation of ten existing food additives via G/SPS/N/JPN/621. The deadline for public comments on the draft proposal is 27 August 2019.



AMIS Policy database

Visit the **AMIS Policy database** at: <http://statistics.amis-outlook.org/policy/>

The **AMIS Policy database** gathers information on trade measures and domestic measures related to the four AMIS crops (wheat, maize, rice, and soybeans) as well as biofuels. The design of this database allows comparisons across countries, across commodities and across policies for selected periods of time.

Only AMIS participants are marked in bold.

International prices

International Grains Council (IGC) Grains and Oilseeds Index (GOI) and GOI sub-Indices

	Mar 2019 Average*	% Change M/M	% Change Y/Y
GOI	189	- 2.8%	- 9.2%
Wheat	189	- 4.3%	+2.7%
Maize	180	- 3.6%	-10.3%
Rice	159	+ 0.1%	- 7.3%
Soybeans	174	- 2.0%	- 15.8%

*Jan 2000=100, derived from daily export quotations

Wheat

Global export prices mostly posted solid declines during March. Pressure continued to come from ample nearby supplies and a generally positive outlook for the next world harvest. The pace of US exports continued to disappoint traders, and this contributed to price weakness for US winter wheats, but US spring wheat export values rose as wintry weather fostered ideas that seeding of the 2019/20 crop could be delayed. EU prices were supported by accelerating exports, including recent sizeable sales to Egypt, Algeria and Saudi Arabia, while, towards the end of the month, new season prices were underpinned by concerns about a dry outlook for some EU crops. Tightening export availabilities buoyed spot quotations in the Black Sea region.

Maize

After gains in the previous three months, the IGC maize sub-Index declined by nearly 4 percent in March, with average prices lower across all origins. Despite early harvest delays, quotations in Argentina were seasonally soft, as reports of excellent yields cemented expectations for a very large crop. Exporters were keen to maintain competitiveness, especially for forward positions when Brazil re-enters the market. Amid comfortable spot availabilities, strong competition for business also weighed on values in Ukraine. While US prices also weakened overall, the downside was capped by difficult

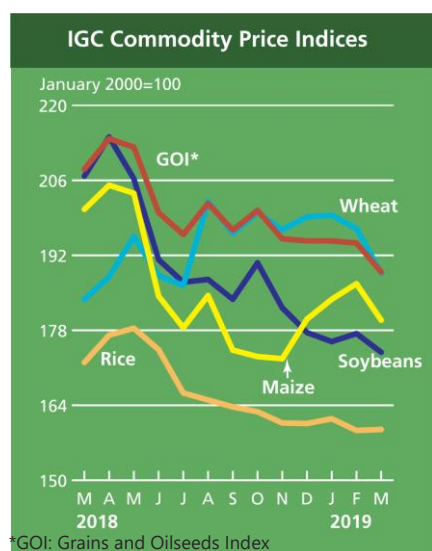
interior logistics and talk that Midwest flooding might reduce or delay spring plantings.

Rice

Average rice prices were broadly unchanged m/m with lower prices in Thailand, amid generally subdued demand and a weaker currency, contrasting with gains elsewhere. Despite harvesting pressure, quotations in Viet Nam were a touch stronger on domestic government procurement and demand from the Philippines, while offers in India gained ahead of the expiry of the non-basmati export subsidy on 25 March. In the Americas, prices were underpinned by declining South American crop prospects, while anticipated sales to Iraq also supported.

Soybeans

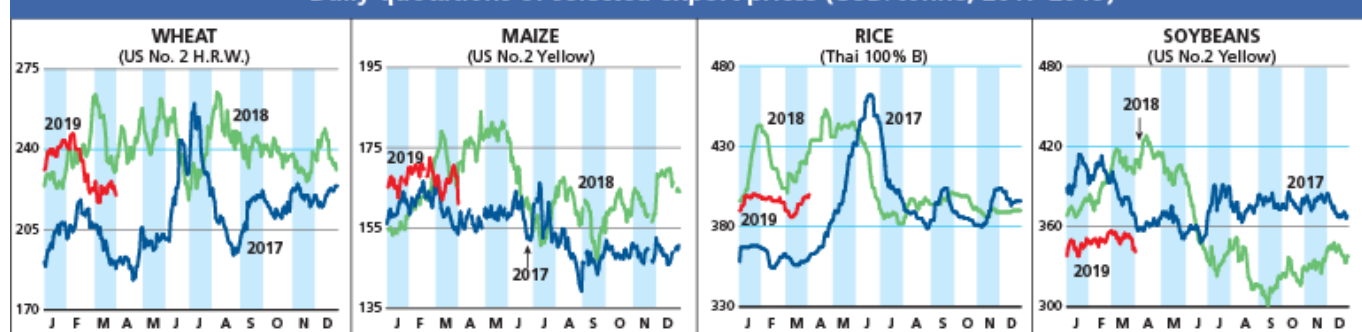
World export values weakened during March, the IGC sub-Index down by around 2 percent, but with contrasting trends across major origins. Average US Gulf quotations were fractionally firmer over the month as hopes for a resolution of the US-China trade dispute underpinned at times, while Midwest logistical difficulties due to adverse weather added support. Nevertheless, gains were capped by sluggish international demand and ideas that delays to US maize fieldwork could encourage farmers to sow additional soybean acres. Seasonal pressure weighed on South American values as harvesting in Brazil advanced to more than two-thirds complete, with currency movements also a factor.



		IGC commodity price indices				
		GOI*	Wheat	Maize	Rice	Soybeans
		(..... January 2000 = 100)				
2018	March	208.1	183.8	200.6	172.0	206.8
	April	213.8	188.0	205.1	177.1	214.1
	May	212.2	195.5	203.6	178.4	206.3
	June	200.0	188.2	184.4	174.4	191.2
	July	195.9	186.4	178.5	166.3	187.0
	August	201.7	202.1	184.5	165.0	187.5
	September	196.7	196.1	174.3	163.7	183.8
	October	200.4	200.0	173.1	162.8	190.6
	November	195.1	196.8	172.7	160.7	182.2
	December	194.7	199.2	180.1	160.6	177.6
	2019 January	194.7	199.5	183.8	161.5	175.9
	February	194.3	197.0	186.7	159.3	177.4
	March	188.9	188.7	179.9	159.5	173.9

Selected export prices, currencies and indices

Daily quotations of selected export prices (USD/tonne, 2017-2019)

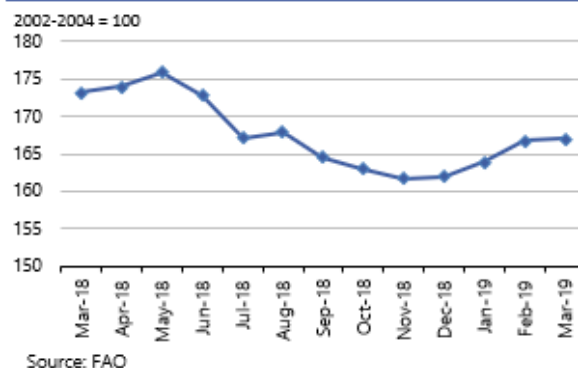
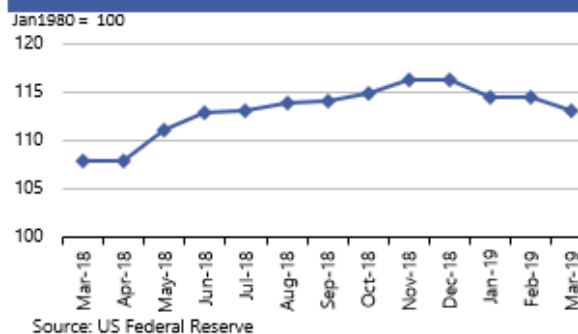


Daily quotations of selected export prices

	Effective Date	Quotation (1)	Month ago (2)	Year ago (3)	% change (1) over (2)	% change (1) over (3)
..... USD/tonne						
Wheat (US No. 2, HRW)	29-Mar	220	222	247	-0.9%	-10.9%
Maize (US No. 2, Yellow)	29-Mar	161	167	177	-3.5%	-9.0%
Rice (Thai 100% B)	29-Mar	400	390	436	2.6%	-8.3%
Soybeans (US No.2, Yellow)	29-Mar	341	357	414	-4.5%	-17.6%

AMIS Countries' Currencies Against US Dollar

AMIS Countries	Currency	March 2019 Average	Monthly Change	Annual Change
Argentina	ARS	41.3	-7.7%	-104.4%
Australia	AUD	1.4	-0.8%	-9.5%
Brazil	BRL	3.8	-3.1%	-17.1%
Canada	CAD	1.3	-1.2%	-3.4%
China	CNY	6.7	0.4%	-6.2%
Egypt	EGP	17.3	1.1%	1.4%
EU	EUR	0.9	-0.4%	-9.2%
India	INR	69.5	2.3%	-6.9%
Indonesia	IDR	14,199.2	-1.2%	-3.2%
Japan	JPY	111.1	-0.6%	-4.8%
Kazakhstan	KZT	378.2	-0.3%	-17.9%
Rep. Korea	KRW	1,131.1	-0.9%	-5.7%
Mexico	MXN	19.2	-0.2%	-3.5%
Nigeria	NGN	305.9	0.0%	0.5%
Philippines	PHP	52.5	-0.7%	-0.8%
Russian Fed.	RUB	65.1	1.0%	-14.0%
Saudi Arabia	SAR	3.8	0.0%	0.0%
South Africa	ZAR	14.4	-4.0%	-21.6%
Thailand	THB	31.7	-1.4%	-1.5%
Turkey	TRY	5.5	-3.5%	-40.3%
UK	GBP	0.8	1.2%	-6.1%
Ukraine	UAH	26.9	0.8%	-2.3%
Viet Nam	VND	23,200.1	0.0%	-1.9%

FAO Food Price Index
Mar 2018-Mar 2019Nominal Broad Dollar Index
Mar 2018-Mar 2019

Futures markets

Futures Prices – nearby

	Mar-19 Average	% Change	
		M/M	Y/Y
Wheat	167	- 9.2%	- 4.5%
Maize	144	- 1.9%	- 3.4%
Rice	237	4.3%	- 12.6%
Soybeans	329	-1.6%	- 13.8%

Source: CME

Futures Prices

Prices for wheat, maize and soybeans declined 9.2, 1.9 and 1.6 percent respectively m/m, owing largely to lackluster demand for US origins. Continued foreign competition drove wheat prices to a one-year low, before rebounding on adverse US weather developments. Soybean and maize values slid early in the month as a trade pact between the US and China remained unresolved. Similar to the wheat price movement, both markets recovered on abnormally wet weather in the Midwest growing regions and reports that China had entered the US maize market for several cargoes. Rice prices performed contrarily to the other markets and rose by 4.3 percent, reflecting in part lower projected US planted acres for 2019/20. Exogenous markets were stronger: US Dollar index and the USD against the Euro rose m/m. West Texas Intermediate crude oil prices - which normally react inversely to USD strength - continued on their rising trajectory, trading as high as USD 60 per barrel, a 33 percent increase since the end of 2018. All four agricultural commodities turned lower y/y, by 4.5, 3.4, 13.8 and 12.6 percent, respectively, for wheat, maize, soybeans and rice, reflecting record or near record global stocks. Following the release of the USDA stocks and planting intentions reports at the end of March, prices for all four commodities fell by varying degrees with maize declining the most by about 5 percent.

Volumes and volatility

Trade volumes for wheat, maize and soybeans fell by about one-third for all three commodities m/m and were lower 13, 15 and 34 percent respectively y/y. Implied volatility and historical volatility edged up m/m for wheat and maize while declining for soybeans. Implied volatility y/y was negligibly higher for wheat and maize, but lower for soybeans, while historical volatility y/y declined for wheat and soybeans and rose for maize.

Basis levels and transport

Domestic basis levels rose marginally m/m for maize and soybeans, but overall indicated ample supplies in the interior for the two commodities. In Illinois, bids to local elevators were quoted minus USD 10 per tonne for maize and minus USD 20 per tonne for soybeans, each under the respective May futures prices. In Iowa, the bids were

Historical Volatility – 30 Days, nearby

	Monthly Averages		
	Mar-19	Feb-19	Mar-18
Wheat	28.1	16.7	30.4
Maize	14.3	13.6	11.1
Rice	17.7	13.8	17.1
Soybeans	11.3	12.5	13.6

slightly higher m/m at minus USD 12 for maize and minus USD 32 for soybeans (under the respective May futures). In soft red wheat, bids for delivery to northern flour mills were quoted at slightly below May futures prices. Gulf export delivery basis levels for maize, soybeans and soft red wheat were all firmer m/m, quoted as high as USD 23, USD 12, and USD 33 (per tonne premium over respective May futures). Multiple lock closures were reported along the Ohio and Mississippi Rivers due to high water as well as pervasive flooding throughout the basin of the Missouri River – which lacks a lock and dam system. The extreme high water, usually occurring in April or May, was accelerated this year by record snowfall in the upper Midwest. Barge freight was firm at about USD 24 per tonne, but lower than late February when floating ice impeded traffic. The US export picture was mixed: cumulative exports were 4 percent lower for wheat and 30 percent lower for soybeans, while 34 percent higher for maize for crop year 2018/19.

Forward curves

Forward curves remained unchanged m/m, persisting in contango configurations (upward sloping). Updates on supply and demand balances from the USDA after the US government resumed normal operations following its 35-day shutdown failed to provide any market surprises.

Investment flows

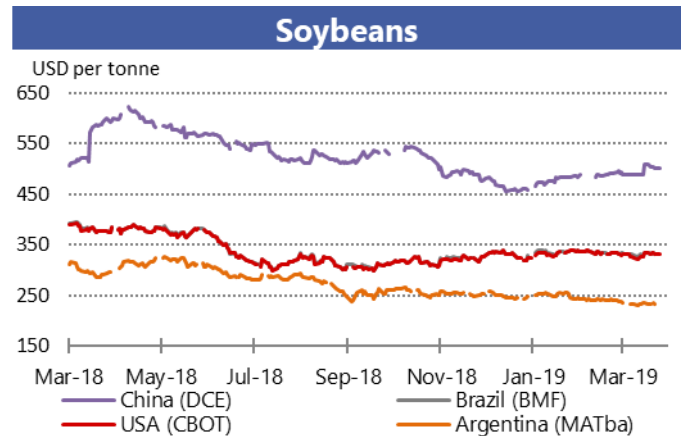
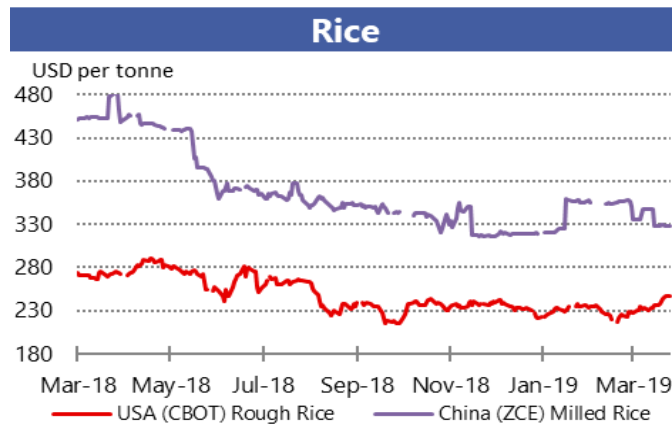
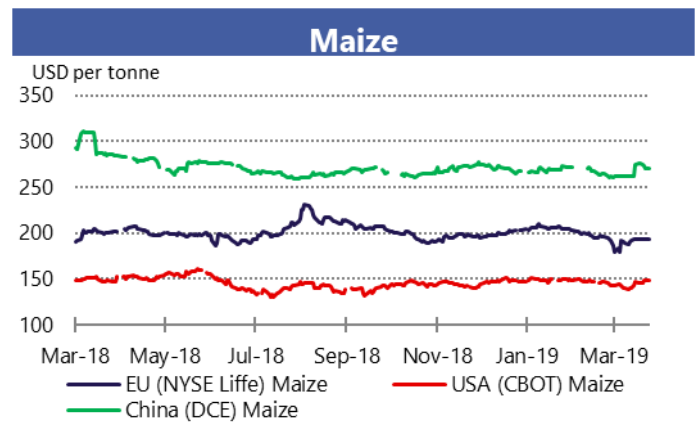
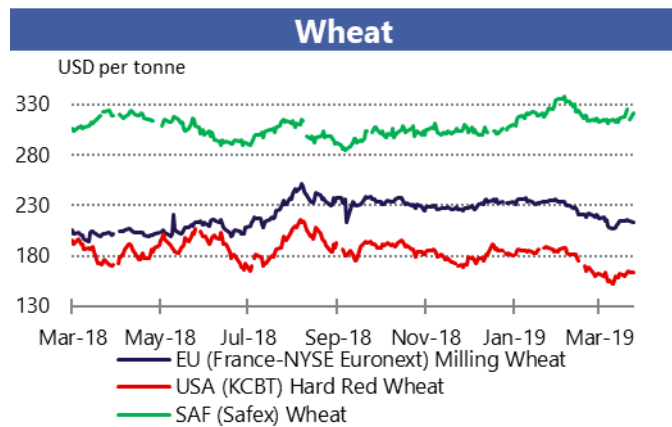
Managed money established large shorts in wheat and soybeans and, in the case of maize, set a record net short of over 283 000 contracts – the equivalent of 36 million tonnes by mid-month. These positions were all moderately reduced prior to the USDA report on stocks and planting intentions. Commercials, which reportedly suffered a downturn in trading revenue due to the US-China trade impasse, held only modest short positions in wheat and maize while positions were even in soybeans. Swaps dealers and Other Reportables (large proprietary traders or speculators) held the dominant long positions in the three commodities.



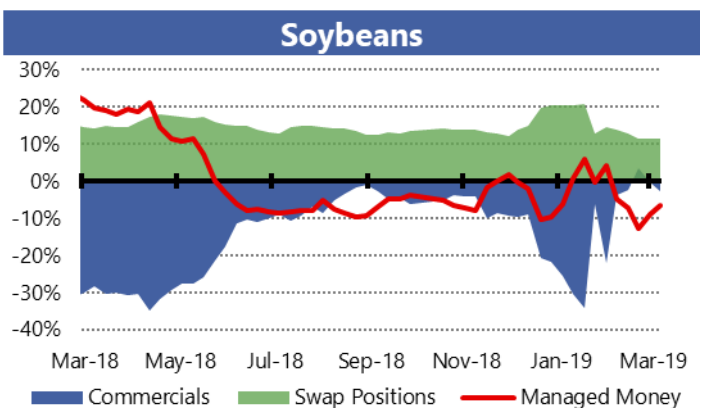
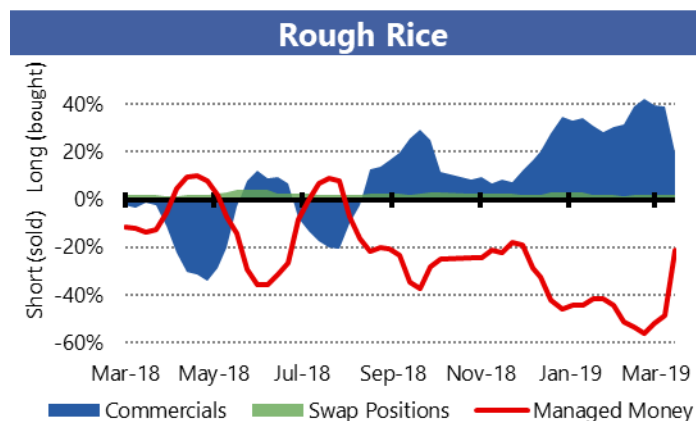
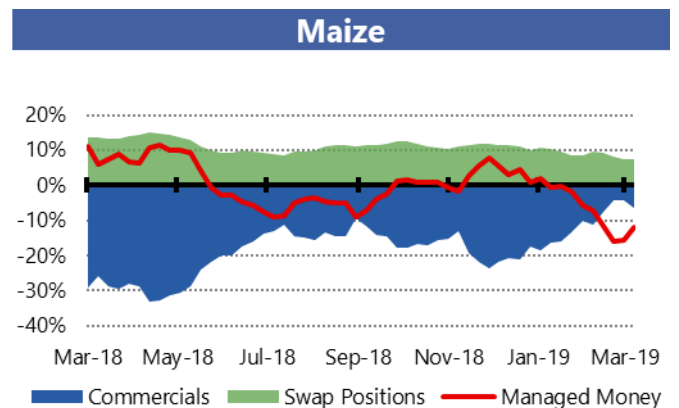
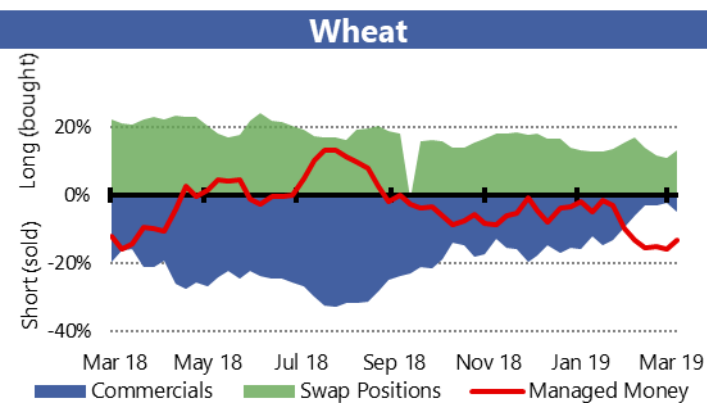
For information on technical terms please view the Glossary at the following link:
http://www.amis-outlook.org/fileadmin/user_upload/amis/docs/Market_monitor/Glossary.pdf

Market indicators

Daily quotations from leading exchanges - nearby futures

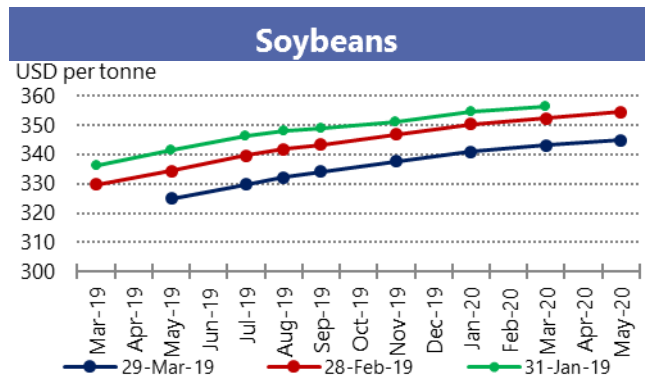
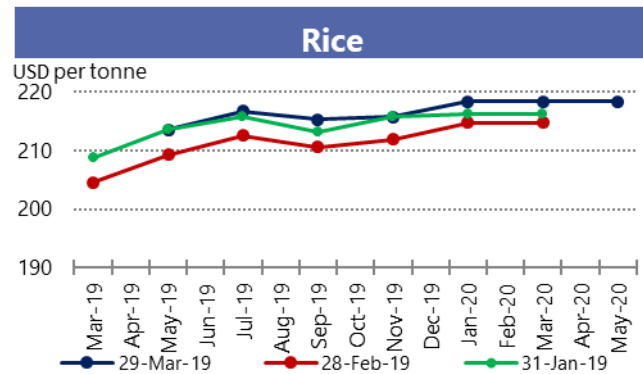
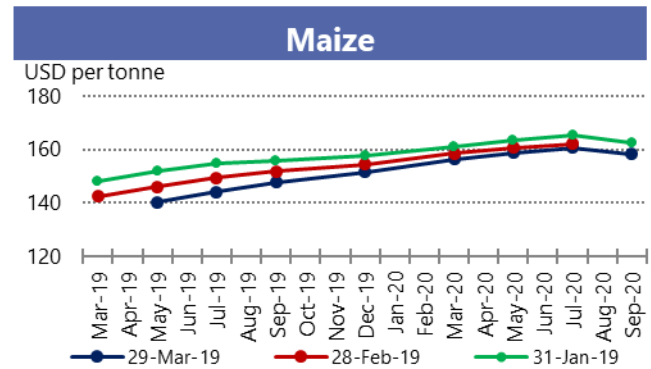
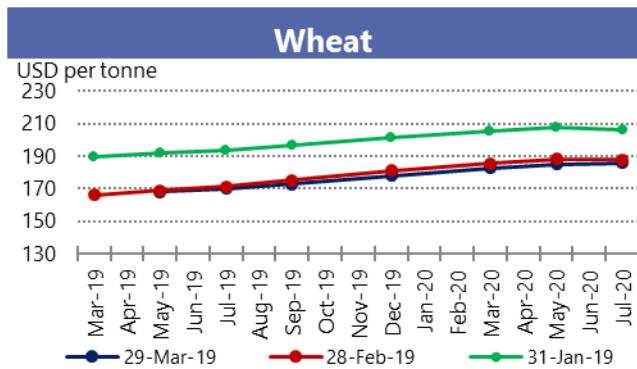


CFTC Commitments of Traders - Major Categories Net Length as percentage of Open Interest*

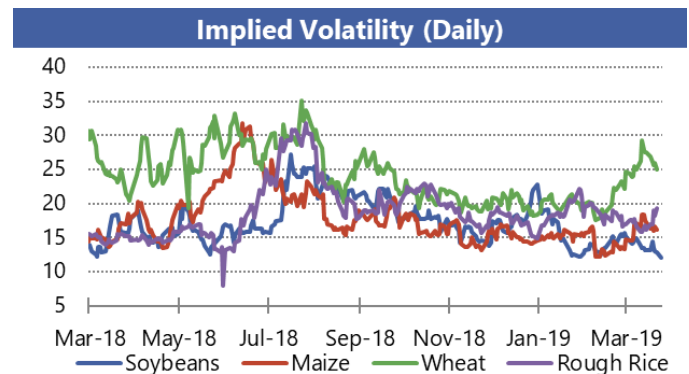
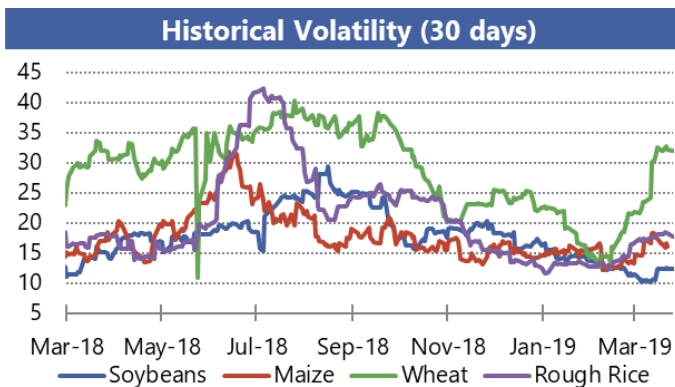


*Disaggregated Futures Only. Though not all positions are reflected in the charts, total long positions always equal total short positions.

Forward Curves



Historical and Implied Volatilities



Monthly US ethanol update

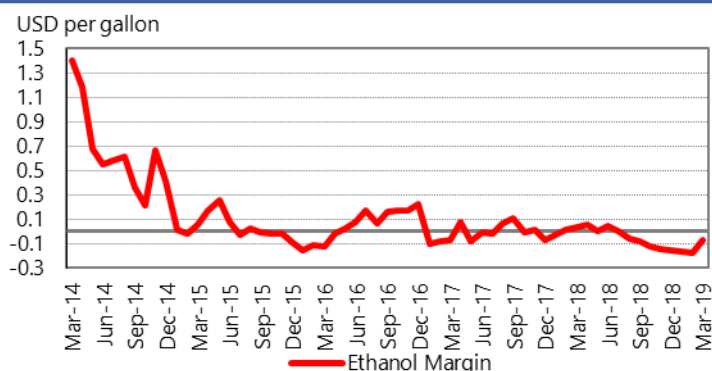
- **Ethanol margins** improved but continued to remain negative in March.
- The improved **ethanol margins** were driven primarily by larger ethanol sales receipts as ethanol prices followed gasoline prices higher.
- **Ethanol production** declined in March to the lowest annualized pace in two years as margins have been negative since fall of 2018.
- The **EPA** announced that further Small Refinery Waivers had been granted for prior years and that more were under consideration which would reduce mandate levels.
- **Ethanol to gasoline futures ratio** fell to below .75 as gasoline prices surged as oil prices have steadily risen.

Spot prices IA, NE and IL/eastern corn belt average	March 2019*	Feb 2019	March 2018
Maize price (USD per tonne)	140.23	141.40	140.52
DDGs (USD per tonne)	144.92	144.44	153.47
Ethanol price (USD per gallon)	1.32	1.24	1.40
Nearby futures prices CME, NYSE			
Ethanol (USD per gallon)	1.36	1.31	1.48
RBOB Gasoline (USD per gallon)	1.84	1.24	1.94
Ethanol/RBOB price ratio	74.0%	88.5%	76.2%
Ethanol margins IA, NE and IL/eastern corn belt Average (USD per gallon)			
Ethanol receipts	1.32	1.24	1.40
DDGs receipts	0.45	0.45	0.47
Maize costs	1.30	1.31	1.30
Other costs	0.55	0.55	0.55
Production margin	-0.08	-0.17	0.03
Ethanol production (million gallons)			
Monthly production total	1 306	1 205	1 353
Annualized production pace	15 375	15 703	15 931

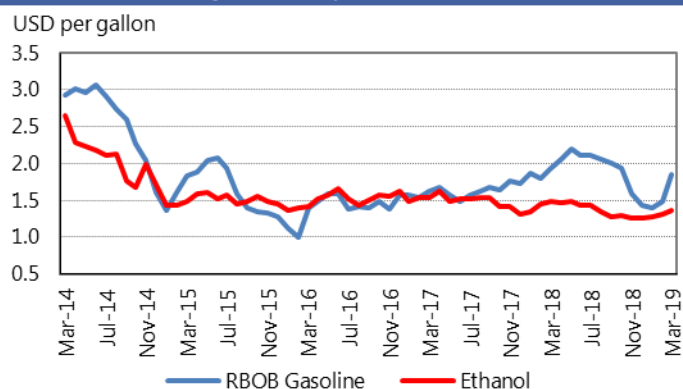
Based on USDA data and private sources

* Estimated using available weekly data to date.

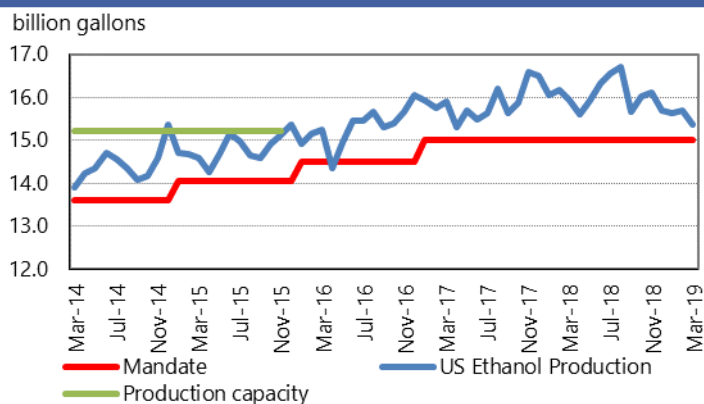
Ethanol Production Margin
(IA, NE, IL/eastern corn belt average)



Ethanol and RBOB gasoline
(nearby futures prices, CME, NYSE)



Ethanol production pace, capacity and annual mandate



Ethanol price vs. maize price
(Spot prices)

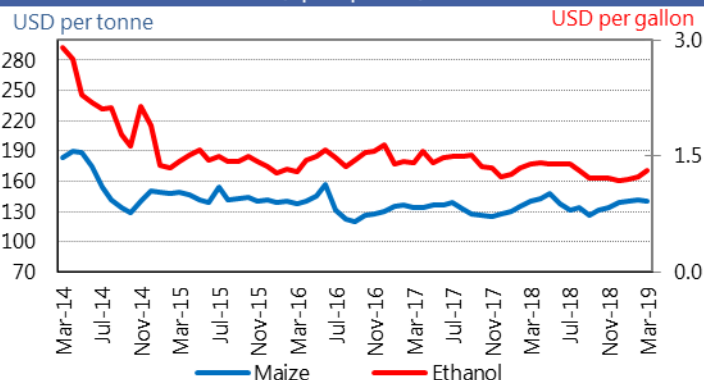


Chart and tables description

Ethanol Production Margins: The ethanol margin gives an indication of the profitability of maize-based ethanol production in the United States. It uses current market prices for maize, Dried Distillers Grains (DDGs) and ethanol, with an additional USD 0.55 per gallon of production costs

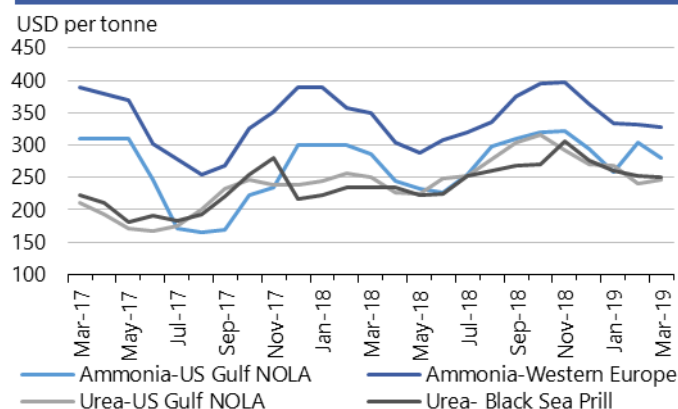
Ethanol Production Pace, Capacity and Mandate: Overview of the volume of maize-based ethanol production in the United States; it also highlights overall production capacity and the production volume that is mandated by public legislation. Name-plate (i.e. nominal) ethanol production capacity in the US is roughly 14.9 billion gallons per annum, but plants can exceed this level, so the actual capacity is assumed to be 15.2 billion gallons.

DDGs: By-product of maize-based biofuel production, commonly used as feedstuff.

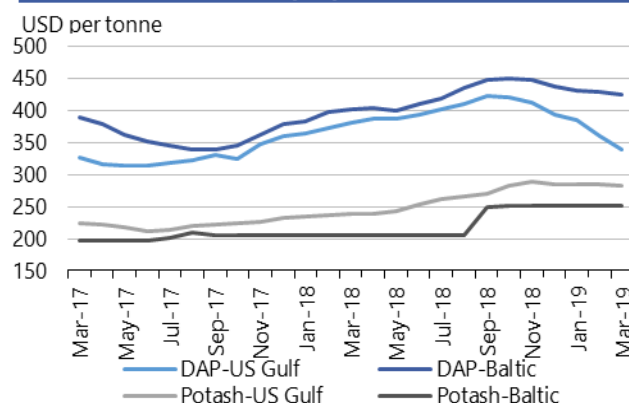
RBOB: Reformulated Blendstock for Oxygenate Blending, gasoline nearby futures (NYSE).

Fertilizer outlook

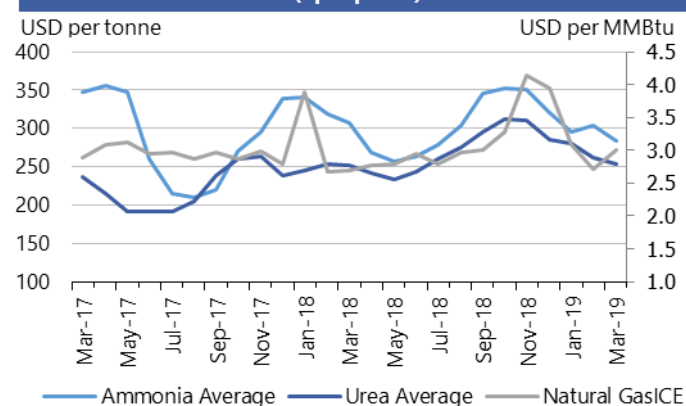
**Ammonia and Urea
(Spot prices)**



**Potash and Phosphate
(Spot prices)**



**Ammonia Average, Urea Average and Natural Gas
(Spot prices)**



- **Natural gas** prices rose by almost 11 percent m/m due to increased heating demand in the US.
- Delays in spring application in the Northern Hemisphere due to wet weather led to oversupply and pushed **ammonia** prices downward, whereas tighter market conditions in Europe helped to stabilize prices in the region.
- **Urea** prices continued their slow decline due to wet weather conditions delaying application in the US.
- **DAP** prices continued to decrease due to a slowdown in global demand.
- **Potash** prices remained stable in the Baltic and marginally decreased in the US due to excess supply.

	March average	March std. dev	% change last month*	% change last year*	12-month high	12-month low
Ammonia-US Gulf NOLA	280.0	50.0	-8.2%	-1.9%	322.0	226.0
Ammonia-Western Europe	328.8	2.5	-1.1%	-6.1%	398.0	289.0
Urea-US Gulf	247.0	9.3	2.4%	-1.4%	315.8	224.0
Urea-Black Sea	250.0	-	-1.0%	6.4%	306.4	223.3
DAP-US Gulf	340.0	4.1	-5.6%	-10.7%	423.8	340.0
DAP-Baltic	425.0	-	-0.9%	5.5%	450.0	400.0
Potash-Baltic	252.0	-	0.0%	22.3%	252.0	206.0
Potash- US Gulf NOLA	282.0	2.3	-0.7%	18.5%	289.2	239.0
Ammonia	284.1	17.2	-6.3%	-7.3%	352.9	256.3
Urea	253.4	1.4	-3.3%	0.8%	312.6	234.0
Natural Gas	3.0	0.3	10.6%	11.6%	4.1	2.7

All prices shown are in US dollars.

Source: Own elaboration based on Bloomberg



Chart and tables description

Ammonia and Urea: Overview of nitrogen-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Western Europe and Black Sea. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.

Potash and Phosphate: Overview of phosphate and potassium-based fertilizer prices in the US Gulf, Baltic and Vancouver. Prices are weekly prices averaged by month.

Ammonia Average and Urea Average: Monthly average prices from Ammonia's US Gulf NOLA, Middle East, Black Sea and Western Europe were averaged to obtain Ammonia Average prices; monthly average prices from Urea's US Gulf NOLA, US Gulf Prill, Middle East Prill, Black Sea Prill and Mediterranean were averaged to obtain Urea Average prices.

Natural Gas: Henry Hub Natural Gas Spot Price from ICE up to December 2017 and from Bloomberg (BGAP) from January 2018 onwards. Prices are intraday prices averaged by month.

Natural gas is used as major input to produce nitrogen-based fertilizers

DAP: Diammonium Phosphate.

Monthly ocean freight market update

Dry bulk freight market developments

	March 2019 Average*	M/M	% Change
Baltic Dry Index (BDI) *	679	+ 8.1%	- 41.1%
<i>sub-Indices:</i>			
Capesize	315	- 55.6%	- 75.9%
Panamax	930	+47.7%	- 40.9%
Supramax	795	+ 42.0%	- 25.4%
Baltic Handysize Index (BHSI)**	433	+ 32.8%	- 30.4%

Source: Baltic Exchange.

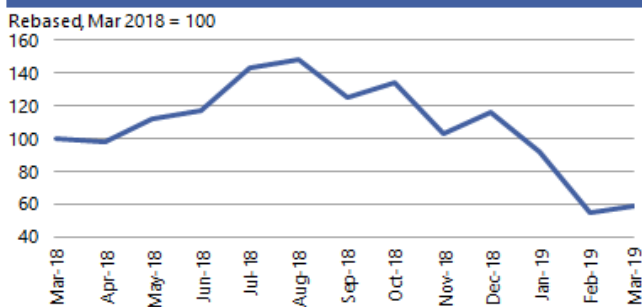
Note: *4 January 1985 = 1000 **23 May 2006 = 1000. Baltic Handysize sub-Index excluded from the BDI from 1 March 2018

- Extended gains in the grains and oilseeds carrying sectors, partly tied to growing optimism about US-China talks, helped the dry bulk freight market to rebound from the multi-month lows of mid-February, as the **Baltic Dry Index (BDI)** averaged 8 percent higher m/m. Nevertheless, reflecting a market which is yet to recover from an early-2019 slump, the Index is significantly lower than a year ago.
- In the **Capesize** sector, the continued fallout from the mining dam collapse in Brazil was compounded by news of fresh coal import restrictions by China and recent weather-induced iron ore mine closures in Western Australia. Against this backdrop, average segment earnings halved m/m, with the corresponding Baltic sub-Index nearly reaching the all-time low of early-2016.
- Driven by robust demand and tight tonnage supply in

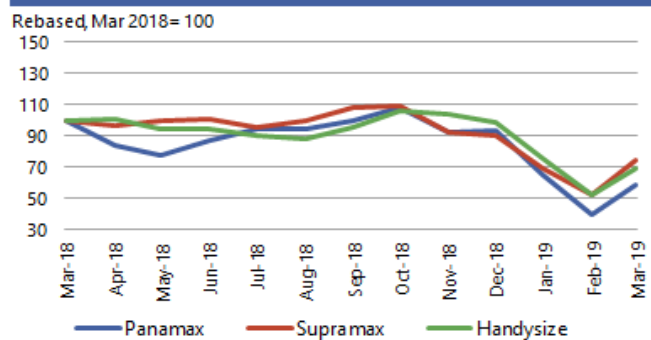
South America, the **Panamax** segment advanced by 48 percent on average. Increasing vessel line-ups, including for grains and oilseeds cargoes, underpinned in the earlier half of March, while minerals trade in Indonesia remained brisk. However, reports of flood-related congestion at the US Gulf and news that some charterers switched to Capesize vessels on Asian routes weighed.

- Supramax** and **Handysize** earnings averaged 42 percent and 33 percent higher, respectively. Both sectors featured strong activity in the Atlantic, which included robust dispatches out of South America and fresh petcoke business at the US Gulf. Markets also witnessed firm enquiries for scrap deliveries, notably from the Baltic to the eastern Mediterranean, and improved rate ideas on Pacific routes.

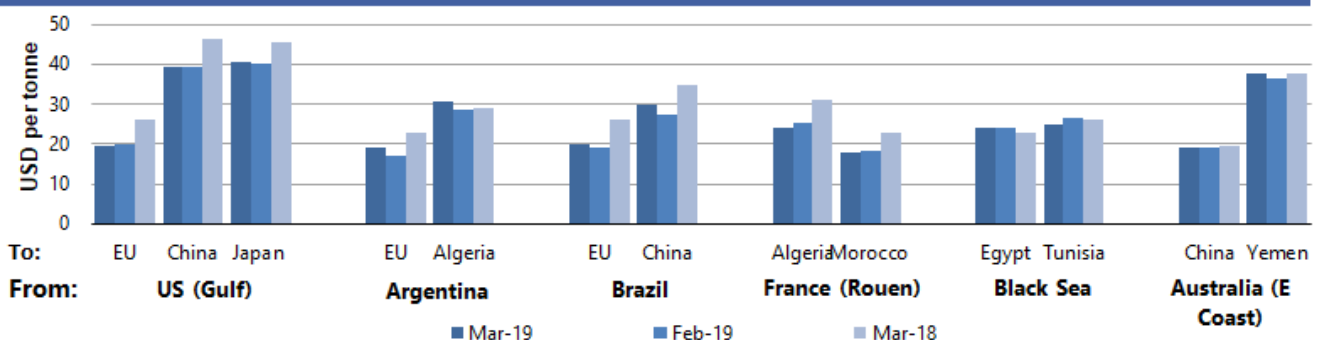
Baltic Dry Index*



Grains and oilseeds carrying sectors: Panamax and Supramax sub-Indices and Handysize Index*



Average nominal freight rates on selected grains and oilseeds routes



i Source: International Grains Council

*monthly average

Baltic Dry Index (BDI): A global benchmark indicator issued daily by the London-based Baltic Exchange, providing an assessment of the costs of moving major raw materials on ocean going vessels. The BDI is a composite measure, comprising sub-indices for four carrying segments, representing different vessel sizes: Capesize, Panamax, Supramax and Handysize.

Capesize: The largest vessels included in the BDI with deadweight tonnage (DWT) above 80 000 DWT, primarily transporting coal, iron ore and other heavy raw materials on long-haul routes.

Panamax: Vessels with capacity of 60 000 to 80 000 DWT, which are mostly geared to transporting coal, grains, oilseeds and other bulks, including sugar and cement.

Supramax/Handysize: Vessels with capacity below 60 000 DWT, which account for the majority of the world's ocean going vessels. They can transport a wide variety of cargoes, including grains and oilseeds.

Explanatory Notes

The notions of **tightening** and **easing** used in the summary table of “Markets at a glance” reflect judgmental views that take into account market fundamentals, inter-alia price developments and short-term trends in demand and supply, especially changes in stocks.

All totals (aggregates) are computed from unrounded data. World supply and demand estimates/forecasts are based on the latest data published by FAO, IGC and USDA. For the former, they also take into account information provided by AMIS focal points (hence the notion “FAO-AMIS”). World estimates and forecasts produced by the three sources may vary due to several reasons, such as varying release dates and different methodologies used in constructing commodity balances. Specifically:

Production: Wheat production data from all three sources refer to production occurring in the first year of the marketing season shown (e.g. crops harvested in 2016 are allocated to the 2016/17 marketing season). Maize and rice production data for FAO-AMIS refer to crops harvested during the first year of the marketing season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season) in both the northern and southern hemisphere. Rice production data for FAO-AMIS also include northern hemisphere production from secondary crops harvested in the second year of the marketing season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). By contrast, rice and maize data for USDA and IGC encompass production in the northern hemisphere occurring during the first year of the season (e.g. 2016 for the 2016/17 marketing season), as well as crops harvested in the southern hemisphere during the second year of the season (e.g. 2017 for the 2016/17 marketing season). For soybeans, the latter approach is used by all three sources.

Supply: Defined as production plus opening stocks by all three sources.

Utilization: For all three sources, wheat, maize and rice utilization includes food, feed and other uses (namely, seeds, industrial uses and post-harvest losses). For soybeans, it comprises crush, food and other uses. However, for all AMIS commodities, the use categories may be grouped differently across sources and may also include residual values.

Trade: Data refer to exports. For wheat and maize, trade is reported on a July/June basis, except for USDA maize trade estimates, which are reported on an October/September basis. Wheat trade data from all three sources includes wheat flour in wheat grain equivalent, while the USDA also considers wheat products. For rice, trade covers shipments from January to December of the second year of the respective marketing season. For soybeans, trade is reported on an October/September basis by FAO-AMIS and the IGC, while USDA data are based on local marketing years except for Argentina and Brazil which are reported on an October/September basis. Trade between European Union member states is excluded.

Stocks: In general, world stocks of AMIS crops refer to the sum of carry-overs at the close of each country's national marketing year. For soybeans, stock levels reported by the USDA are based on local marketing years, except for Argentina and Brazil, which are adjusted to October/September. For maize and rice, global estimates may vary across sources because of differences in the allocation of production in southern hemisphere countries.

For more information on AMIS Supply and Demand, please view [AMIS Supply and Demand Balances Manual](#).

Main sources

Bloomberg, CFTC, CME Group, FAO, GEOGLAM, IFPRI, IGC, Reuters, USDA, US Federal Reserve

AMIS - GEOGLAM Crop Calendar

Selected leading producers

Wheat		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
EU (21%)*	winter												
China (17%)	spring												
	winter												
India (13%)	winter												
US (8%)	spring												
	winter												
Russia (8%)	spring												
	winter												
Maize		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
US (35%)													
China (22%)	north												
	south												
Brazil (8%)	1st crop												
	2nd crop												
EU (7%)													
Argentina (3%)													
Rice		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
China (29%)	intermediary crop												
	late crop												
	early crop												
India (21%)	kharif												
	rabi												
Indonesia (9%)	main Java												
	second Java												
Viet Nam (6%)	winter-spring												
	summer/autumn												
	winter												
Thailand (4%)	main season												
	second season												
Soybeans		J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
USA (31%)													
Brazil (29%)													
Argentina (18%)													
China (4%)													
India (3%)													

* Percentages refer to the global share of production (average 2013-15).

	Planting (peak)		Harvest (peak)
	Planting		Harvest
	Weather conditions in this period are critical for yields.		Growing period

2019 AMIS Market Monitor Release Dates

February 7, March 7, April 4, May 9, June 6, July 4, September 5, October 3, November 7, December 5

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